

KANAV NANDA

+91-6284877725 | [linkedin.com/in/nandakanav](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nandakanav) | kanavnanda965@gmail.com

BTech – Data Science, Economics and Business | Plaksha University

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Data Science, Economics and Business <i>Plaksha University</i>	CGPA: 8.86	2024–2028
Class 12 – CBSE <i>Ryan International School, Chandigarh</i>	86.4%	2023
Class 10 – CBSE <i>Ryan International School, Chandigarh</i>	96.6%	2021

RESEARCH PROJECTS AND COURSEWORK

Checkmates and Incentives <i>Prof. Prakarsh Singh, DSEB Chair</i>	December 2025 – Present
- Leading a research team of 3 examining gender differences in chess performance under extreme time pressure using move-level tournament data. - Built a large-scale tournament dataset beginning from Candidates 2024; findings show women’s blunder rates under severe time pressure are 23% higher compared to men in equivalent game states.	
Out-of-Pocket Healthcare Expenditure Analysis <i>Prof. T.V. Ramanathan,</i>	February 2026 – May 2026
- Analyzed 11M+ data points from 50,000 households using regression analysis and statistical modeling; proved better district infrastructure reduces out-of-pocket costs by 4.3%. - Uncovered an insurance paradox: insured families are 1.5x more likely to face catastrophic medical costs due to inadequate coverage limits.	
Framing Bias Detection in News Headlines <i>Prof. Siddharth,</i>	January 2026 – May 2026
Developed a Small Language Model (SLM) using natural language processing (NLP) to predict media bias severity on a continuous 1.0–10.0 scale, improving prediction performance by 50% over baseline NLP Models.	
AI and Economic Behavior: Modified Ultimatum Game <i>Prof. Vasudha Chopra,</i>	January 2026 – May 2026
Designed a 2x2 factorial between-subjects experiment and built a networked oTree platform for participants to test how AI-assisted unearned income influences the Entitlement Effect and bargaining behaviour.	
Stabilized Cosine Annealing Adam (SCAA) Optimizer <i>Prof. Ashish Kumar,</i>	October 2025 – December 2025
Engineered SCAA, a custom deep learning optimizer combining Adam, cosine annealing, warmup, and restart using Python and PyTorch; achieving 23.8% faster convergence than Adam on ill-conditioned optimization benchmarks and 96.25% accuracy on MNIST classification.	

WORK EXPERIENCE

Student Junior Teaching Assistant <i>Young Technology Scholars (YTS) 2026</i>	March 2026 – June 2026
Selected to support faculty in curriculum delivery for 30+ students across emerging technology topics; co-building a hands-on project demonstrating energy conversion via tree-climbing and hydropower systems.	
Event Operations Intern <i>Chopra Audio Visual, Investor Punjab Summit</i>	March 2026
Facilitated execution for the Punjab Investor Summit attended by 1000+ participants, coordinating across vendors, audio-visual teams, and logistics to ensure seamless event delivery.	
Business Operations Intern <i>Dope Lifestyle</i>	May 2026 – Present
Rotating across cross-functional teams; shadowing the founder for direct exposure to business strategy, product decisions, and day-to-day management.	

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

Head of Sponsorship and Finance <i>Model United Nations Society, Plaksha University</i>	August 2025 – Present
- Secured strategic partnerships with The New Shop and MYOP, delivering cash funding and in-kind resources for the annual Model United Nation competition. - Managed end-to-end sponsor negotiation, contract management, and budget tracking	

SKILLS

Programming	Python, SQL
Libraries	NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, Scikit-learn
Tools	Microsoft Excel, MySQL, Canva, oTree, Stata, Power BI
Domain Skills	Data Analysis, Statistical Modeling, Econometrics, NLP, Experimental Design, Financial Modeling
Certifications	McKinsey Forward Program – Foundational Business and Leadership

ACHIEVEMENTS AND AWARDS

- Case and Strategy:** 1st Place at Ashoka Behavioural Case Competition 3.0 (**400+ teams**); Semi-finalist at Grant Thornton National Case Competition (**900+ teams**), one of India’s most competitive consulting challenges; 1st Place at Founders Crucible Case Competition (40+ teams); 3rd Place at Cascade (25+ teams).
- Finance and Markets:** 1st Place at MarketCraft, Ashoka University (**125+ teams**) – macroeconomic crisis defence before a finance jury; 3rd Place at Fintech Venture Lab (**185+ teams**) – built *Krishisetu*, an agricultural credit scoring model with live HTML interface, defending unit economics before industry investors; 1st Place at Mergers and Acquisitions (25+ teams); 3rd Place at Finance Among Us (20+ teams).
- Entrepreneurship and Technology:** 1st Place at How I Met My Investor, E-Cell Plaksha (25+ teams); 1st Place at Dhanda Paani (10+ teams); 3rd Place at Leverage, Colossus Tech Fest (12 teams); 3rd Place at Startup Sprint (20+ teams).